

EMEM ESSIEN

Risk Management, Security Management, and Privacy Management.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

- 9+ years' experience across Information Security, GRC, Cloud Security, Data Privacy, Risk Management, and IT Compliance in enterprise and SaaS environments.
- Led vulnerability and patch management programs in partnership with DevOps and engineering teams, applying risk-based prioritization and remediation tracking.
- Built and operated third-party risk management (TPRM) programs, including vendor assessments, ongoing monitoring, and issue remediation.
- Led SOC 2, ISO 27001, and regulatory audits, managing relationships with auditors, regulators, and customer security reviews.
- Strong analytical, problem-solving, and operational risk skills, with a track record of prioritizing initiatives and meeting delivery timelines.
- Effective communicator and collaborator, able to present security and risk insights to technical teams and senior leadership.

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS & STANDARDS

Certifications:	Certified Information Systems Security Professional – <i>CISSP</i>
	Certified Cloud Security Professional - <i>CCSP</i>
	Systems Security Certified Practitioner – <i>SSCP</i>
	Certified Ethical Hacker - <i>CEH</i>
	Certified Information Privacy Manager – <i>CIPM</i>
Compliance Standards:	NIST, ISO 27001, SOC 2, HIPAA, HITRUST, FedRAMP, PIPEDA, GDPR, TX-RAMP

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior GRC Analyst – [Kobalt.io](https://kobalt.io), Vancouver 2023 – 2025

- Led the design, implementation, and ongoing governance of information security policies, standards, and procedures aligned with ISO 27001, SOC 2, NIST CSF, and other internationally recognized security frameworks, ensuring alignment with organizational risk appetite and business objectives.
- Executed key components of enterprise security and compliance programs across multiple frameworks (ISO 27001, SOC 2 Type I & II), driving automation, repeatability, and continuous control monitoring to support scalable audit readiness and ongoing compliance.
- Acted as a trusted advisor to senior leadership by delivering risk-based guidance, conducting cybersecurity risk assessments, and recommending risk mitigation strategies, compensating controls, and residual risk acceptance in alignment with enterprise risk management practices.
- Established, maintained, and operationalized cybersecurity risk registers, enabling leadership to identify, assess, prioritize, track, and remediate risks based on likelihood, impact, and business criticality.
- Partnered closely with engineering, DevOps, and SRE teams to triage security vulnerabilities, perform structured risk analysis, and prioritize remediation using severity scoring (e.g., CVSS), threat modeling, and business impact analysis within agile and CI/CD environments.
- Served as the primary liaison for external auditors, customers, and third-party assessors, managing SOC 2 and ISO audit readiness, coordinating evidence collection, addressing audit findings, and ensuring sustained compliance with regulatory, contractual, and industry requirements.

- Provided senior-level ERM and GRC leadership, guiding risk analysts and partnering with business, security, and engineering teams to align enterprise risk management activities with organizational objectives and risk appetite.
- Led the review, enhancement, and operationalization of GRC and risk management policies, ensuring alignment with cloud-native, SaaS operating models, regulatory requirements, and cybersecurity best practices.
- Assessed, documented, and reported enterprise, operational, and cybersecurity risks related to business initiatives, cloud services, and third-party relationships, enabling informed risk-based decision-making by leadership.
- Conducted ongoing risk identification, assessment, and control effectiveness reviews, recommending risk mitigation strategies and compensating controls across security, privacy, and compliance domains.
- Partnered with cross-functional teams to track key risk indicators, remediate control gaps, and support internal and external audits.

Security & Privacy Analyst – Breathe Life, Montreal

2022 – 2022

- Aligned security, privacy, and GRC operations with business objectives across cloud, SaaS, and enterprise environments, improving overall organizational security posture.
- Advised engineering and DevOps teams on secure coding, application security, and privacy compliance (GDPR, HIPAA, CCPA) throughout the SDLC.
- Designed and delivered security awareness programs including phishing simulations, reducing human-related cybersecurity risks.
- Performed comprehensive risk assessments, third-party/vendor risk evaluations, and application security testing (SAST, DAST, code review) to identify, prioritize, and remediate vulnerabilities.
- Developed and enforced security policies, standards, and controls aligned with ISO 27001, SOC 2, NIST CSF, and CIS Controls.
- Led privacy and data protection initiatives, including DPIAs, data inventories, and RBAC implementation, ensuring compliance and secure cloud configurations (AWS, Azure, GCP).
- Monitored and analyzed security operations using SIEM tools to detect anomalies, investigate incidents, and ensure regulatory compliance.
- Partnered with cross-functional teams to track key risk indicators, remediate control gaps, and support internal and external audits.

Service Desk Analyst – WBM Technologies, Regina

2019 – 2022

- Delivered enterprise and client-focused IT support with a strong emphasis on cybersecurity, identifying and resolving technical and security-related incidents impacting clients and business operations in a timely manner.
- Escalated and coordinated cases with incident response, network, and application security teams for investigation, risk analysis, and resolution, ensuring business continuity and threat mitigation.
- Created and maintained onboarding training materials for new employees, fostering analytical thinking, security awareness, and informed risk-based decision-making to improve operational efficiency and reduce security exposure.
- Supported IT security and privacy initiatives, enforcing organizational policies and regulatory compliance (e.g., GDPR, HIPAA, SOC 2) while aligning day-to-day operations with corporate security objectives.
- Monitored and reported security events, assisting in vulnerability identification and remediation while maintaining client trust and data protection standards.

Building Automation Technician – Honeywell Building Solution, Regina

2018

- Designed and implemented secure automation solutions, including firewalls, access controls, and networked control systems, aligning with customer specifications and security best practices.
- Monitored and troubleshoot building automation systems, identifying and resolving vulnerabilities or operational anomalies, demonstrating incident detection and response skills.

- Led IT and operational technology (OT) system transformations, transitioning from onsite service models to cloud-based platforms, highlighting experience with secure remote access and cloud security considerations.
- Enforced privacy and data protection policies, ensuring that sensitive operational and client data was handled in compliance with regulatory requirements.
- Documented system configurations, workflows, and incident reports, supporting auditing, compliance, and risk management processes.
- Collaborated with engineering and IT teams to implement system upgrades, troubleshoot security incidents, and integrate secure communication protocols.

Customer Service Technician – AFL Global and Ledcor (SaskTel Contractors), Regina

2014 – 2018

- Installed and terminated fiber optic and copper cabling for residential customers, including TV, internet, and phone services.
- Performed splicing, fusion, and connectorization of fiber optic cables to ensure low-loss, high-reliability network connections.
- Conducted signal testing and troubleshooting using OTDR, power meters, and optical light sources to validate installation quality and network performance.
- Maintained and repaired existing network infrastructure, including troubleshooting outages and performing preventive maintenance on fiber and copper lines.
- Documented installations and service activities accurately for work orders, network maps, and quality assurance reporting.
- Ensured compliance with safety protocols and local regulations during all fieldwork, including proper handling of fiber optic materials.
- Provided customer support and education, explaining network setup and resolving connectivity issues on-site.

Security Analyst/System Administrator – Nigeria LNG Limited and Marina Securities Limited, Nigeria

2007 – 2009

- Conducted security risk assessments of IT assets, organized staff security awareness sessions, and monitored network activity for potential threats.
- Evaluated emerging IT products, services, protocols, and standards in support of the organization's business requirements and development efforts, using network penetration technology.
- Participated in LAN and network infrastructure projects, helping to deliver multi-floor office network deployments in alignment with NIST security guidelines.
- Collaborated with third-party vendors to assess system and network requirements, assisting in the implementation of solutions within approved budgets.
- Maintained and documented IT systems, ensuring compliance with security policies, risk management procedures, and organizational standards.
- Provided operational support for system administration tasks, including user access management, network configuration, and troubleshooting security or connectivity issues.

EDUCATION

Foundations of Risk Management

University of Toronto, Canada

2023

Master of Applied Science in Industrial Systems Engineering

University of Regina, Canada

2013

Bachelor of Engineering in Electronics Engineering

University of Nigeria, Nigeria

2006